Community Stabilization Unit - Early Recovery Initiative

Community Atmospheric Panels

BARIRE

SOUTHWEST STATE OF SOMALIA | MARCH 2026

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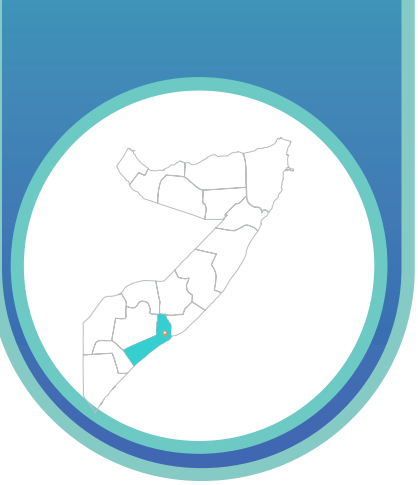

CAPs

Areas of focus

Living conditions

Recovery initiatives

Governance

Security

Justice

Media

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report outlines the findings of Community Atmospheric Panel (CAP) consultations conducted in Barire (Bariire) town, Southwest State of Somalia, between 25 and 30 November 2025. The exercise aimed to assess early recovery needs and inform priorities across local governance, security, access to justice, media use, and humanitarian response.

The CAP revealed a complex post-conflict landscape in Barire, characterised by incremental security gains juxtaposed with profound humanitarian, socio-economic, and governance challenges. The Somali National Army (SNA) and African Union Support and Stabilisation Mission in Somalia (AUSSOM) have restored stability, particularly in the town centre, facilitating the initial return of displaced populations and fostering trust through local engagement, especially by the SNA Gorgor unit. Despite these improvements, security remains fragile, as the absence of civilian policing and the potential withdrawal of international forces could reverse recent gains. Most households continue to reside in partially destroyed or unsafe shelters, with limited access to essential services, including healthcare, education, and clean water. Vulnerable groups—particularly women, children, the elderly, and persons with disabilities—are disproportionately affected, while youth and minority populations experience high unemployment, limited participation in governance, and exclusion from decision-making. Return to Barire remains partial, with men often returning ahead of women and children due to ongoing insecurity and inadequate services.

Recovery and reconstruction efforts are minimal and fragmented. Government-led initiatives are largely absent, and non-governmental interventions have been sporadic, limited in scope, and sometimes hindered by transparency and coordination challenges. As a result, residents have relied heavily on community-led coping strategies for housing repairs, livelihood support, and social cohesion. Critical priorities identified include the rehabilitation of water infrastructure, repair of housing, reconstruction of schools, health facilities, and mosques, and the establishment of a functioning police presence to consolidate security gains. Governance structures remain nascent and highly clan-centric, with minimal inclusion of women, youth, and minority groups. Justice mechanisms are predominantly informal, relying on traditional Xeer and Shariah systems. Information flows primarily through community-based channels, with national media and social platforms considered less reliable.

Social and Economic Challenges

- High unemployment
- Shelter shortages
- Service shortages
- Destroyed livelihoods

Governance and Security Challenges

- Clan dominance
- Limited inclusion
- Weak institutions

To support Barire's transition from fragile post-conflict conditions to sustainable stability, a multi-faceted, coordinated approach is required. Key recommendations include establishing civilian policing and functional courts, strengthening inclusive governance and civic capacity, rehabilitating critical infrastructure, restoring essential services, promoting youth employment, and ensuring sustainable access to water. Coordination through a multi-stakeholder recovery task force involving federal and local authorities, security actors, NGOs, and community representatives is essential to align humanitarian, development, and reconstruction efforts. These integrated measures aim to consolidate security gains, address immediate humanitarian needs, and foster social inclusion, economic recovery, and long-term stability in Barire town.

Demographics and Geographic Profile

Barire is a small but strategically important town located along the Shabelle River in Lower Shabelle region, approximately 50–60 km southwest of Mogadishu. Administratively, the town falls under Afgoye District and lies along a key supply and movement corridor linking Afgoye and Awdhegle. This route is vital for trade, livelihoods, and access to agropastoral areas inhabited by Digil, Biyamal, Somali Bantu, and Hawiye communities. The town maintains strong economic and social linkages with Afgoye and Mogadishu, facilitating market access, employment opportunities, and long-standing community coexistence. Its riverine setting supports agriculture and agropastoral livelihoods, further reinforcing its local economic importance.

Population estimates remain imprecise. Local government officials estimate that approximately 5,000 households reside in Barire; however, this figure is not definitive due to displacement and population movement linked to insecurity. From a security perspective, Barire has experienced fluctuating control. Currently, security forces, including the SNA and AUSSOM, are present. Despite this security presence, large segments of the population have not returned. Many residents remain displaced due to fear of al-Shabaab retaliation and targeted attacks against civilians perceived to be cooperating with authorities. Displaced families have relocated to nearby and distant urban centres, notably Afgoye and Mogadishu.

METHODOLOGY

The methodology combined qualitative participatory approaches to ensure inclusive, reliable, and context-specific data collection. In the week preceding the CAPs consultations, the research team undertook community mobilisation and sensitisation activities to prepare local stakeholders for the Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) and Key Informant Interviews (KIIs). This preparatory phase aimed to enhance community ownership, improve participation, and ensure that respondents clearly understood the objectives and process of the exercise. All facilitators obtained informed consent from participants prior to the commencement of discussions. Engagements were guided by a structured and pre-tested questionnaire, allowing for consistency across sessions while providing sufficient flexibility for participants to elaborate on key issues. Discussions were conducted in a respectful and interruption-free environment to encourage open and candid contributions.

Participants were selected and organised into three distinct FGDs, each comprising 10 participants, to ensure representation of diverse community perspectives: elders, women, and youth. Each FGD followed a semi-structured discussion format and lasted approximately three hours, enabling in-depth exploration of thematic issues and collective validation of community priorities. In addition to the FGDs, five KIIs were conducted to triangulate findings and provide expert insights. Key informants included the District Commissioner, an education professional, a community chieftain, a businessperson, and a youth chairman. Each KII lasted between 30 and 60 minutes, allowing for a detailed examination of sector-specific perspectives and governance dynamics.

In total, 35 individuals participated in the study, comprising 10 women (35%) and 25 men (65%). All discussions were audio-recorded, with participants' consent, and subsequently reviewed and analysed to ensure accuracy, consistency, and reliability of the findings.

25 - 30 November

CAPs group discussions

Participants were divided into:

3

Focus Groups

Focus groups composition

Female

Male

Key discussion points

- Recovery efforts & humanitarian stabilisation
- Perceptions of community safety and major security threats
- Governance & local leadership

All respondents were interviewed in person, with the exception of three key informants—the clan chieftain, a professional, and a businessperson—who were unavailable to attend physically due to prior commitments. These KIIs were conducted remotely to ensure their perspectives were incorporated into the analysis.

FINDINGS

Security and Political Conditions

Overview and Needs of Security Actors

Security in Barire has improved markedly since the joint deployment of the SNA and AUSSOM (Ugandan contingent) in August 2025. Before this, the town faced persistent attacks by al-Shabaab due to limited government presence. Sustained joint operations have significantly reduced incidents, particularly in the town centre. Despite improved stability in the town centre, rural areas remain vulnerable. Al-Shabaab does not maintain a visible presence inside Barire but is active approximately 10 km west of the town, across the Shabelle River. Its proximity continues to pose a latent threat.

The SNA is the primary security actor, with Gorgor units playing a central operational role. They conduct patrols, man checkpoints, and coordinate with elders on intelligence. The SNA personnel are drawn from multiple clans across Somalia and are widely trusted by the community. AUSSOM maintains a smaller, supporting presence focused on force protection and securing key routes. AUSSOM maintains two bases on the outskirts of the town and conducts joint patrols with the SNA to support law and order.

A critical gap remains the absence of formal police, Southwest State regional forces, and structured community policing mechanisms. Security remains military-led, limiting progress toward civilian law enforcement and durable rule-of-law systems. Key needs include sustained logistical support and strengthened community-based intelligence mechanisms..

Perceptions of Security Actors

Respondents describe security in Barire as stable, primarily due to the presence of the SNA and AUSSOM forces. They reported stronger communication and collaboration with the SNA than with AUSSOM, although both are recognised for enhancing security. Community perceptions are shaped by past incidents in which AS temporarily overran Barire after overwhelming SNA forces during a major confrontation. Control was later restored through renewed military operations supported by AUSSOM. This experience reinforces the view that continued partnership between national forces and international support is essential to prevent a security vacuum.

While respected for its stabilisation role, AUSSOM is perceived as having less familiarity with local dynamics.

The community clearly prefers the SNA to remain the lead security provider, with complementary support from AUSSOM. Despite current stability, elders, women, and local intellectuals expressed concern about a potential AUSSOM withdrawal. They emphasised that AUSSOM's presence helps deter insurgency and compensate for limited government capacity. Respondents stressed that any withdrawal should be gradual and accompanied by strengthened police, administrative, and governance structures. Women, in particular, noted that improved security has significantly benefited vulnerable groups and warned that reduced patrols or logistical support could lead to renewed insecurity.

Al-Shabaab does not enjoy community trust. Respondents cited harassment, illicit taxation, and intimidation as reasons for widespread rejection across youth, elders, and women. Elders expressed strong confidence and trust in the Gorgor unit, highlighting its close integration with the local community. In particular, they commended the 4th Battalion, under Commander Hassan Dahir, for its community-oriented approach and responsiveness to local concerns. Elders also praised Commander Abdikadir Gab of the 5th Battalion for maintaining constructive cooperation and respectful engagement with residents. In contrast, while acknowledging AUSSOM's indispensable role in stabilisation, elders noted that its limited familiarity with local socio-cultural dynamics sometimes constrains effective community interaction and trust-building.

Respondents noted that SNA forces have established a strong, constructive rapport with the local population. This relationship has been particularly important in encouraging internally displaced residents to return, as SNA personnel have provided assurances of safety and protection. Elders highlighted symbolic yet meaningful indicators of positive civil–military relations, noting that local youth frequently share meals and interact socially with SNA personnel, a practice viewed as a clear sign of mutual trust, acceptance, and social cohesion

Overview of Government Structure & Representation

Local governance in Barire is currently dominated by two principal clans. The District Commissioner was appointed from the Abajibil sub-clan of Digil, which constitutes the majority population in the district, while the Deputy District Commissioner is from the Garre sub-clan of Digil. Participants agreed that these two clans hold the most influential leadership positions within the local administration. No other clans are represented in the current governance, which is in an early post-conflict recovery phase and lacks inclusive mechanisms. Elders noted limited participation by minority clans, women, and youth, and described the arrangements as provisional. Youth acknowledged they do not face overt clan-based marginalisation but have a limited understanding of district operations. Many youths want to engage in governance and need capacity-building in administration, civic education, and leadership.

Several participants described the local administration as largely non-functional, with only the District Commissioner and Deputy Commissioner in place, operating without formal offices, staffing, or logistical support. In this context, governance remains largely symbolic. Participants explained that pervasive insecurity has forced both community members and local leaders to prioritise immediate survival and personal safety over longer-term governance concerns.

During the CAP, participants consistently reported the absence of any formal

or structured relationship between Barire's local administration and higher levels of government, including the Federal Government of Somalia (FGS) and the relevant Federal Member State (FMS). Youth participants, in particular, highlighted this disconnect, noting that while the District Commissioner and Deputy Commissioner were officially appointed, their roles appear largely isolated from broader government systems. At the same time, they acknowledged that the District Commissioner has established a pragmatic and collaborative relationship with the Gorgor military unit and the local community. One participant noted, **"The DC and Gorgor work together well. They listen to people and sometimes help bring in NGOs."** This cooperation was viewed as one of the few functioning coordination mechanisms in the district.

Perceptions of Government Structure & Representation

Despite challenges, participants reported an absence of active political rivalries in Barire. During the FGDs, elders explained that the community remains preoccupied with recovering from conflict, displacement, and widespread destruction, leaving little space for political competition or factionalism. As one participant remarked, **"People are more worried about rebuilding their homes and finding food than fighting over politics."** Another added, **"Right now, everyone is just trying to survive—there's no space for political arguments."**

Youth participants reinforced this assessment, noting that the lack of functional governance structures, beyond the District Commissioner and his deputy, has effectively precluded the emergence of political groups, processes, or contests. As one youth explained, **"No real administration or elections are happening, so there's no room for political conflict yet."** The District Commissioner similarly observed that the absence of formal institutions, councils, or political platforms has limited opportunities for rivalry, while clan relations remain largely cooperative under a shared objective of stabilisation and recovery.

Regarding trust in government, elders expressed cautious and mixed views. While acknowledging the FGS in principle, participants reported minimal engagement or visible support from regional government authorities. Many described feelings of neglect, stating that the absence of meaningful interaction has eroded confidence in the regional government's capacity to support Barire's recovery.

Economic Conditions

Current Living Standards

During the assessment, participants consistently highlighted the sharp deterioration in living conditions following the ousting of AS in August 2025. While the security situation within the town has improved as a result of the presence of the SNA and AUSSOM, these gains have not yet translated into improved socio-economic conditions for the population. Participants emphasised that daily living standards remain critically low, with most households struggling to meet even basic needs.

Elder participants reported that extensive destruction of residential housing during the conflict has left a significant proportion of returnee families without adequate shelter.

Many households are currently residing in makeshift structures constructed from salvaged materials or occupying partially damaged and structurally unsafe buildings. These conditions expose residents to environmental hazards and significantly undermine their safety, dignity, and overall wellbeing. Elders stressed that women, children, the elderly, and persons with disabilities are particularly vulnerable, as they face heightened risks due to inadequate shelter, limited access to basic services, and ongoing protection concerns.

Participants further noted that the pace of return remains uneven. According to a local intellectual from the district, the majority of those who have returned to Barire thus far are men—primarily elders and youth rather than entire family units. Women and children, he explained, are often left behind in displacement locations due to concerns over security, lack of shelter, and the absence of essential services such as healthcare, water, and education. This partial return pattern reflects the cautious approach adopted by families, who are testing conditions on the ground before committing to full resettlement.

A critical concern raised consistently across all participant groups was the acute shortage of safe and reliable water. Participants reported that the majority of boreholes were either damaged or deliberately destroyed during the conflict, leaving the community with extremely limited local water sources. One elder explained, **"The only borehole that still works gives us dirty water. Without AUSSOM and SNA bringing water, we would not survive."** Participants emphasised that reliance on external water deliveries exposes the community to severe vulnerability should security conditions change or humanitarian support be interrupted. As described by elders, the water crisis is emblematic of broader humanitarian needs facing Barire, underscoring the urgent requirement for assistance—particularly in water infrastructure rehabilitation, housing reconstruction, and the restoration of basic public services.

NGOs Activities

While some participants acknowledged limited engagement by non-governmental organisations (NGOs), they emphasised that current interventions are sporadic and insufficient relative to the scale of destruction and need. Overall, participants called for a coordinated and sustained recovery approach, led by government authorities and supported by development and humanitarian partners, to move beyond emergency assistance toward durable solutions that rebuild infrastructure, restore essential services, and enable the safe and sustainable return of displaced populations. Women participants stressed that women and children bear the brunt of inadequate shelter, food insecurity, and limited access to services, yet there are no targeted government programmes addressing their specific needs. Participants noted that this lack of targeted assistance has heightened protection risks and further strained already fragile household coping mechanisms.

When asked to identify any interventions that had positively impacted the community, participants cited two initiatives:

1. Assessment and registration by CPD:

- The youth commissioner explained that the Centre for People and Development (CPD) conducted an assessment in August 2025, during which approximately 300 vulnerable individuals were registered for potential future assistance. Youth participants viewed this as a modest but encouraging step; however, many expressed skepticisms about whether the registration would translate into tangible support. As one youth noted, **"We registered, but so far, nothing has happened."**
- Participants raised significant concerns regarding the transparency and fairness of the beneficiary registration and selection process conducted by the CPD. Women participants expressed strong dissatisfaction, stating that the targeting criteria were neither clearly communicated nor consistently applied. Many felt that genuinely vulnerable households—particularly female-headed households and families with young children—were excluded without explanation. One woman noted that the absence of clarity around selection fueled frustration and mistrust within the community. Elders echoed these concerns, emphasising that community leaders were not consulted or involved in the registration process.

2. Food distribution by SODMA:

- All participants acknowledged a food distribution carried out by SODMA in August 2025, during which rice was provided to approximately 300 households. While the District Commissioner welcomed the assistance, he characterised it as temporary and insufficient to address the community's needs. Women participants raised concerns regarding the fairness and transparency of the distribution process, reporting that some vulnerable households were excluded while others reportedly received multiple shares due to favouritism.
- The District Commissioner further clarified that Barire had initially been allocated food assistance for 500 households. However, according to his account, 200 food bags were diverted to Awdhegle District by SODMA in coordination with the Awdhegle District Commissioner. Participants cited this incident as emblematic of broader challenges related to coordination, accountability, and equitable aid distribution.

Recovery Efforts

Formal recovery efforts in Barire remain extremely limited. Participants emphasised that most assistance currently comes from community-led efforts, with residents relying on personal resources to rebuild damaged homes and provide informal support to returning families. From the perspectives shared during the youth FGD and by the youth commissioner, the absence of structured recovery programmes has also left many young people feeling marginalised and disengaged from the recovery process.

Elders stressed that post-liberation recovery has largely stalled at the security phase. Little progress has been made in addressing broader community needs, including the rehabilitation of basic services, infrastructure, and livelihoods. Elders cautioned that without tangible recovery interventions, the sustainability of current stability remains uncertain. Youth participants echoed these concerns, describing a persistent lack of follow-up support aimed at restoring social services or creating economic opportunities, leaving many young people idle and uncertain about their future.

Overall, participants concluded that current recovery support in Barire remains fragmented, inadequate, and heavily reliant on community resilience. They stressed the urgent need for coordinated, transparent, and inclusive recovery interventions that address immediate humanitarian needs while laying the groundwork for sustainable reconstruction and long-term stability.

IDPs Considerations

Participants consistently reported that Barire currently functions primarily as a source of displacement rather than a host community for internally displaced persons (IDPs). Elders explained that intense fighting and widespread destruction forced the majority of residents to flee, with many families seeking refuge in nearby locations such as Afgoye, Elasha-Biyaha, and other surrounding settlements. Participants also referenced the Gondarere IDP site, located approximately 3 km from Barire. Although relatively accessible, the elders clarified that the site primarily shelters individuals displaced from Barire and its immediate environs. It does not operate as a formal or structured settlement for IDPs from other regions, but rather as a temporary refuge for those directly affected by the conflict in Barire.

Community Perceptions

Women participants echoed concerns with particular emphasis on access to healthcare and food security. They highlighted that movement restrictions have made it increasingly difficult for pregnant women, nursing mothers, and children to reach Maternal and Child Health (MCH) centres or to travel to nearby towns to obtain basic necessities.

Youth participants reported high levels of unemployment, driven largely by insecurity that restricts access to farmland and livestock. This has significantly reduced household income and exacerbated economic hardship. Youth further stressed that critical sectors, including housing, education, healthcare, and infrastructure, remain neglected. Public facilities were destroyed during the conflict, and no meaningful reconstruction has occurred. As one youth stated, **"Our schools are gone, there are no clinics, and there's nothing for young people—no jobs, no support programmes. We feel forgotten."** Participants warned that without targeted youth-focused recovery interventions, long-term stability will remain elusive.

Youth participants raised additional concerns regarding restricted movement in and out of Barire following the deployment of SNA and AUSSOM. While recognising that these measures are intended to prevent infiltration by al-Shabaab, which is still believed to be active in surrounding rural areas, youth participants stressed that the restrictions have had significant negative impacts on daily life, employment opportunities, and social interaction. They noted that these limitations are not the result of isolated incidents but form part of broader preventive security strategies, underscoring the need for a more balanced approach that safeguards security while enabling mobility and economic recovery.

Minority groups in Barire continue to experience underrepresentation in local governance structures. Participants emphasised the need for inclusive decision-making and equitable civic participation. They noted that integrating minority groups, namely Somali Bantu, who are mainly farmers, into local authority roles would enhance governance legitimacy, strengthen social cohesion, and improve responsiveness to community needs. No census estimates the actual number of Somali Bantu residents, but they are marginalised and regarded as a minority in the village.

Justice Systems

Participants described a plural justice environment in Barire, encompassing traditional (Xeer), Shariah, and formal justice systems. The choice of mechanism depends on case type, accessibility, and the presence of relevant authorities.

Traditional (Xeer): Xeer remains the most widely used and accessible system, particularly for civil disputes such as land issues, family conflicts, and compensation (Diya) cases. Elders from different clans mediate these disputes, drawing on customary norms. Participants described the system as familiar, swift, and effective in maintaining social harmony.

Shariah Law: Shariah principles are preferred for family-related matters such as marriage, divorce, and inheritance. However, displacement and limited access to qualified religious scholars have constrained consistent application.

Formal: The formal justice system is least utilised due to the absence of functioning courts, legal offices, or police in Barire. Participants described it as inaccessible, slow, and costly. People go to Mogadishu or Afgoye to access the formal justice system, which is costly and time consuming, so they prefer available means of customary law. Serious criminal cases may be referred to government or military courts when national security is implicated.

Participants identified multiple barriers to accessing justice, including:

- » Insecurity and fear of reprisal, particularly from al-Shabaab
- » Absence of formal justice institutions, including courts and police
- » Overreliance on informal systems, which may disadvantage women and minorities
- » Discrimination and exclusion of women, youth, and smaller clans
- » Financial constraints, including travel and legal costs
- » Low legal awareness of rights and procedures

Women participants emphasised that the absence of a police station and judicial infrastructure is the primary barrier to justice, calling for urgent establishment of formal justice mechanisms.

Media and Information Accessibility

Participants reported that mobile phones are the primary means of accessing information, supplemented by radio applications and social media. Elders, youth, and women highlighted the importance of community-based communication, particularly in the absence of formal media infrastructure. Youth rely heavily on WhatsApp and phone calls, while women prefer direct communication with trusted relatives and neighbours. Local authorities acknowledged that community communication networks play a critical role in information-sharing, particularly for security-related updates.

Participants expressed a strong preference for local, trusted sources of information. Approximately two-thirds reported relying on the SNA—particularly the Gorgor unit—for security updates, citing proximity and credibility. Others rely on elders and religious leaders to verify information. Social media and national outlets were widely viewed as unreliable or delayed. Women highlighted barriers such as limited media literacy, access to devices, and cultural constraints. Participants collectively called for inclusive, community-focused media—such as local radio programming—to address health, safety, education, and recovery needs in a culturally appropriate manner.

CONCLUSION & RECOMMENDATIONS

The assessment of Barire village highlights a complex post-conflict environment where tangible security improvements coexist with profound socio-economic and governance challenges. The presence of the SNA and AUSSOM has restored a degree of stability, particularly within the town centre, creating conditions for initial returns of displaced populations. Community members consistently praised the Gorgor unit for its local engagement and trust-building, while acknowledging the indispensable stabilisation role of AUSSOM. However, respondents expressed concern that the withdrawal of international forces or the absence of formal civilian security structures could undermine recent gains. Despite enhanced security, the district faces severe humanitarian and recovery gaps. Most households continue to live in partially destroyed homes or temporary shelters, with access to basic services—including healthcare, education, and clean water—remaining critically limited. Vulnerable populations, particularly women, children, and persons with disabilities, are disproportionately affected. Displacement persists, and many returnees face constant fear of renewed insecurity, restricted mobility, and economic hardship.

Governance structures remain nascent, highly clan-centric, and largely symbolic. The District Commissioner and Deputy Commissioner are operational, but there is minimal vertical or horizontal linkage with the FGS, FMS authorities, or formal local councils. Women, youth, and minority groups continue to experience exclusion from decision-making processes. This governance vacuum has reinforced perceptions of neglect and limited community confidence in state institutions. The economic situation mirrors these challenges. Destruction of infrastructure and ongoing access restrictions have stifled livelihoods, exacerbated unemployment, and constrained access to markets and services. Youth and minority groups are particularly marginalised, highlighting the urgent need for inclusive recovery initiatives that connect security gains to sustainable development.

Justice mechanisms are primarily informal, with the traditional Xeer system dominating civil dispute resolution and Shariah applied in family matters. The formal justice system remains largely inaccessible, and the absence of a functioning police presence and judicial infrastructure limits accountability and protection, particularly for women and minority populations. Overall, Barire illustrates a fragile post-conflict setting where security improvements have not yet translated into social, economic, or political recovery. Without coordinated interventions across governance, livelihoods, public services, and justice, the stability achieved through military presence risks being temporary.

The following recommendations are proposed to consolidate gains, address urgent gaps, and foster sustainable recovery in Barire:

- **Transition from military-led security to civilian policing:** Strengthen law and order and reduce reliance on SNA and AUSSOM. Deploy trained Somali Police Force (SPF) officers to Barire, rehabilitate or establish a police post and conduct joint patrols with SNA and AUSSOM. Establish a rapid response and community reporting mechanism.
- **Rehabilitate justice institutions:** Establish local courts and legal aid services to improve access to formal justice, particularly for women, youth, and minority groups to restore rule of law and improve access to justice, particularly for women, youth, and minority groups by rehabilitating the local court facility or deploying mobile courts during the initial phase, establishing of a legal aid desks and paralegal support or even train the local justice actors on case management and protection principles.
- **Promote inclusive governance structures:** Establish a district council with equitable representation of women, youth, and minority groups through the facilitation of community consultations and selection processes. Form the district council with quotas for women, youth, and minority groups and develop basic governance bylaws. These actions will strengthen legitimate and representative local governance structures.
- **Strengthen civic education and local administrative capacity:** Train youth and community leaders to participate effectively in governance, enhancing transparency and accountability to improve participation and transparency in local governance.
- **Rehabilitate critical infrastructure:** Prioritise repair of roads, bridges, boreholes, schools, and healthcare facilities to restore mobility, access to services, and basic livelihoods. These could be achieved by repairing feeder roads, and small bridges, schools, health post and boreholes.
- **Support housing reconstruction for returnees:** Provide materials, technical support, or conditional cash transfers to enable safe, voluntary and sustainable return of displaced populations through the provision of shelter kits and construction materials.
- **Develop youth employment and skills programmes:** Create vocational training, apprenticeships, and income-generation initiatives like supporting small-scale income generating activities and linking trained youth with local markets and employers to reduce unemployment-driven vulnerability and promote social cohesion. Potential key actors are the Ministry of Youth and Sports, NGOs, private sector partners, or local elders.
- **Restore essential public services:** Rehabilitate the MCH centre, schools, and mosques to support physical and psychosocial recovery.
- **Ensure reliable access to clean water:** Repair damaged boreholes and establish sustainable water management systems to reduce reliance on emergency trucking and improve resilience.